MADISON CURLING CLUB EVENT RULES

Effective October 31, 2022

The following rules shall apply to all curling events (leagues) at the Madison Curling Club except Mixed Doubles and as otherwise noted.

1. USA Curling Rules of Curling and Competition shall govern all play, except when in conflict with the Madison Curling Club rules, which take precedence. The rules of the USA Curling will be posted at the curling club. *Note: Rule R7 (No-Tick Rule) is only in effect for USA Curling Championship Events and will not be utilized during MCC events (leagues).*

2. There shall be free substitution except as otherwise provided by these rules.

3. A legal team shall consist of a minimum of three curlers, at least two of whom must be regular members of the team.

4. If the skip is absent, any other team member may skip.

5. If a team is not a legal team at the start of the scheduled draw, the team will be penalized one point for each ten-minute delay. In addition, that offending team will automatically throw first rocks when the game starts. A 30-minute delay will constitute a forfeit.

6. Winning teams shall be responsible for cleaning and pebbling the ice after each draw.

7. Winning thirds shall immediately mark the results of completed games. Posted event sheets shall serve as the official record. Failure to mark a game result by the conclusion of play of the last week of the event shall result in forfeits for both teams for the unmarked game(s).

8. Only members may participate in event games. Members are those who have paid their dues as designated by the Board of Directors. Any games in which a nonmember participates shall be forfeited.

9. Games shall begin on time. A bell shall sound, as outlined in the Bell Rule Policy, indicating that teams may complete the end and finish the game. An end shall be considered completed when all rocks in play have come to rest. If the last end results in a tie score, one more end will be played to determine the victor. Failure to comply with this rule shall result in forfeiture of the game by both teams unless an extra end is played because of a tie. If an extra end is played, the skips for the following shift may mark the scoreboard with the “E” placard, indicating that this sheet has played an extra end. If a sheet is so marked, the teams on that sheet may complete the end being played and play one more following the sounding of the bell. Failure to mark the scoreboard at the beginning of the match forfeits this opportunity.

10. All games shall be scheduled during regularly scheduled nights and times, and shall *not* be scheduled at an alternate site, on an alternate time or weeknight, or before/after the scheduled beginning or ending date of the event, unless the Event Chair / Shift Captain obtains approval from the Games Committee Chair in advance. No tiebreaker games shall be played. Event winners, except Mansfield and Champagne Cup, will be established based on the Event Tiebreaker Rules, which are posted on club bulletin boards.

11. All games shall be played when scheduled except as follows:
    A) The opposing skips may agree to play the scheduled game prior to or after its scheduled date, but the game may not be played at an alternate location, or before or after the last scheduled game for the event, unless the Event Chair obtains approval from the Games Committee in advance.
    B) If the skips cannot agree on a date for the rescheduled game, the team requesting the reschedule shall record a loss for the scheduled game.
    C) The team requesting the reschedule should notify the Event Chair / Shift Captain with the date of the rescheduled game as soon as agreed upon. Once the rescheduled date and time has been received by the Event Chair / Shift Captain, it is considered to be scheduled, and any further rescheduling is subject to Rules 10 (A), (B), and (C).

12. Rules 12 (A) through 12 (J) apply to all events with established point limits, except Champagne Cup.

A) Teams shall be limited to a maximum point total determined by the Games Committee. Each team member shall be assigned a point rating to be determined by the Rating Committee. Any new member with previous curling experience must be rated by the Rating Committee. Only the Rating Committee can assign points.

B) The Games Committee, Event Chairs, and Shift Captains shall maintain the roster of team personnel and positions.

C) If a team loses one of its members for an extended period due to illness, transfer or some other reason, a written request for a replacement must be given to the Event Chair.

D) A substitute may not play in a higher roster position than the curler being replaced. A substitute may curl in only two games in succession for the same team during the regular season. During the Mansfield Championship, a substitute may curl with the same team throughout, subject to Rule 12 (I).

E) If a substitute's point rating puts a team over the maximum, the team will be penalized one point for every point the team is over the limit. It is the responsibility of each skip to notify the opposing skip prior to the game if the team is over-pointed. The penalty points will be awarded at the end of the first end in which the opposing team scores, except as covered in Rule 12(F). Failure to give penalty points will result in forfeit.

F) If a curler is tardy, the game will start with three curlers as covered in Rule 12(G). If playing with three puts the team over in points and the tardy curler misses more than two ends, penalty points will be awarded as covered in Rule 12(E).

G) If there are only three curlers present on a team, the two curlers who are not the skip throw three rocks each; the points will be adjusted by adding ½ of the total points of each of these players to determine the team's total points. Should this arrangement result in the team being over in allotted points for the event, the team has the option of having the lead curler deliver four rocks, and the points of the curler delivering four rocks shall be doubled to determine the point total of the team. Should either arrangement result in the team being over in allotted points for the event, it is the team's discretion which arrangement they wish to use, and Rule 12(E) will apply.

H) Unless otherwise specified by the Games Committee, all games shall be eight ends or less as covered in Rule 9. In case of a tie, an extra end shall be played as covered in Rule 9. During the Mansfield Championship, there are no time limits on games.

I) In the Mansfield Championship, a substitute must come from the pool of players who held a permanent position in Mansfield for at least one half of the season and may not play in a lower position than recorded by the Games Committee; e.g., a regular skip may not substitute as vice-skip, second or lead. A regular vice skip may not substitute as a second or lead. A regular second may not substitute as a lead.

J) In the Mansfield Championship, a substitute may not be used if the team would then be over the point limit. The team may play with three and in such case Rule 12 (G) shall apply.

13. Skips, Shift Captains, and Event Chairs are responsible for enforcing these rules. Protests should be made at the time of the infraction of the rule to the opposing skip or third, should the skip be a substitute. The Games Chair should be informed of the alleged infraction within 48 hours and the Games Committee must rule upon the alleged infraction within a reasonable period of time, but in no case after the last scheduled game of the event.

THESE RULES SHALL NOT BE WAIVED.

Madison Curling Club Event Tiebreakers
(Excluding Mansfield and Champagne Cup Events)
Effective October 31, 2022

Note that **no tiebreaker games will be played**. All event winners will be determined by applying the following criteria in the order shown. If more than two teams are involved in a tiebreaker scenario, one or more of the teams can be removed from contention at any given stage of the criteria, at which point the criteria are reapplied to the remaining teams until a winner is identified. It is NOT a "one tie, all tie" situation.

Based on the size of the event, an Event Chair may decide to create a schedule of pool/division play. Event Chairs who utilize pools/divisions are strongly encouraged to reserve the last week of scheduled play for a Championship Week.

For Events Without Pools or Divisions:
At the end of scheduled play, all teams shall be ranked according to the following Ranking Procedure:

1. Overall W/L in event by at least "one full game[1]." Games not yet played and/or recorded by the conclusion of scheduled play will be marked as losses.
2. Head-to-head competition, assuming all involved teams have played each other. Again, the "one full game" rule is in effect.
3. Lowest Draw Shot Measurement (see Draw Shot Guidelines)
4. Coin flip amongst teams still remaining in contention

After ranking, if the 1st seed team has at least a *full game lead* over the 2nd seed team, they will be declared the Event Champion, *regardless of the results of a Championship Week*. If the 1st seed team has less than a full game lead over the 2nd seed team, a Championship Week may be used to determine the Event Champion. If the event does not have a Championship Week, the above criteria should be utilized to determine the Event Champion.

If utilized, the Championship Week shall be scheduled as follows after ranking:

--1st seed plays 2nd; 3rd plays 4th; etc.

--If there are an uneven number of teams or there are more games than available sheets, the team(s) with the lowest seed will not play, unless a higher ranked team chooses not to play

[1] ***Full Game Rule*:** It may happen that not all teams will play the same number of games in an event's schedule. For this reason, teams within one half game of each other will be considered "tied." If one team finishes with a 8-1 record, they would be "tied" with a team with a 7-1 record. An 9-0 team versus a 8-1 team is not considered tied because they are separated by one full game. If we have a 8-1 team, a 7-1 team, and a 7-2 team, the 7-2 team is not "tied" with the other two as they are one full game behind the 8-1 team. Should further clarification or determination be needed, consult with the Games Committee Chair.

For events with pools / divisions:
At the end of scheduled pool/divisional play, all teams in each pool shall be ranked according to the following Ranking Procedure:

1. Overall W/L in event by at least "one full game[1]." Games not yet played and/or recorded by the conclusion of scheduled play will be marked as losses.
2. Head-to-head competition, assuming all involved teams have played each other. Again, the "one full game" rule is in effect.
3. Lowest Draw Shot Measurement (see Draw Shot Guidelines)
4. Coin flip amongst teams still remaining in contention

After ranking each pool/division using the above criteria, the Championship Week shall be scheduled as follows:

--1st seed in Pool 1 plays 1st seed in Pool 2 (winner is Event Champion)
--2nd seed in Pool 1 plays 2nd seed in Pool 2, etc.
--If there are an uneven number of teams or there are more games than available sheets, the team(s) with the lowest seed will not play, unless a higher ranked team chooses not to play

In rare instances, and in consultation with the Games Chair, an Event Chair with larger pools (8+ teams/pool) may decide to hold a Championship Game after the conclusion of scheduled event play. Event participants should be notified of the additional game at the beginning of scheduled play. In this instance, the teams shall schedule their game within a week of the conclusion of the event (not play, but **schedule**) and notify the Event Chair of the date and time agreed upon. Should the teams not be able to determine a time, the Event Chair shall schedule the game in consult with the Games Chair.

Draw Shot Guidelines:
The Draw Shot Measurement will be used for tie-breaking purposes and will follow the guidelines outlined below:

1. Draw shots shall be completed and recorded by the completion of the eighth week of the event. Teams that fail to complete the Draw Shot by that time will be marked as "X", which is ranked below 72" for purposes of tiebreakers.
2. Please be considerate of time and subsequent shifts when deciding to complete your draw shot. Draw shots may not be thrown if it is already past the start time of the next shift.
3. One team member shall throw one stone (no practice stones) with two sweepers at the conclusion of the game and a measurement to the nearest ½" taken from the button.
4. Draw shots must be thrown by an official member of the team (no subs). A player who was a sub in the game may sweep or hold the broom.
5. The skip or vice-skip of the opposing team shall complete the measurement. This measurement is to be agreed upon by the throwing team's skip or vice-skip and the individual completing the measurement, and recorded on the event schedules located on the bulletin board. Failure to touch the house results in a measurement of 72".
6. Should both teams desire to throw in one evening, the first stone is to be removed from play after the measurement is complete.
7. Measuring tapes will be located with the pebble can in the equipment room, along the back wall on the home end of the icehouse, or other designated area.

REMEMBER THE SPIRIT OF CURLING!

THE EVENT CHAIR AND/OR GAMES CHAIR SHALL RESOLVE ANY MATTERS NOT PROVIDED FOR ABOVE.

DETERMINATION OF MANSFIELD EVENT PLAYOFF PARTICIPANTS – 2022-23

28 Teams will advance to the Playoffs at the conclusion of the Regular Season:

Tuesday 4:30	
Top two teams first half; top two teams second half	4 Teams
Tuesday 6:30/8:30	
First half winner; second half winner	2 Teams
Wednesday 4:30	
Top two teams first half; top two teams second half	4 Teams
Wednesday 6:30/8:30	
Top two teams first half; top two teams second half; 2 Wild Card	6 Teams
Thursday 5:00	
Top two teams first half; top two teams second half	4 Teams
Thursday 7:00/9:00	
Top two teams first half; top two teams second half	4 Teams
Event Wild Card	4 Teams

In arriving at the playoff participants, First Half Winners shall be determined first, then First Half Runners-up (where applicable), then Second Half Winners, then Second Half Runners-up (where applicable), then Shift Wild Cards (where applicable), and finally the "Event Wild Cards." That should be kept in mind while reading through the following tiebreaker criteria. Note that **no tiebreaker games will be played**. Everything will be settled following the conclusion of the last game of Thursday late, by applying the following criteria. The criteria shall be applied in the order shown. If more than two teams are involved, one or more of the teams can drop out of contention at any given stage of the criteria. It is NOT a "two tie, all tie" situation.

Not all teams will play the same number of games in a given half. For this reason, teams within one half game of each other will be considered "tied." (This is the "**one full game**" rule.) Thus, if one team finishes one half with a 9-0 record, they can be tied by another team on the same shift that finishes with an 8-0 record. In baseball parlance, these two teams are only a half game apart and thus, for our purposes, considered tied. 9-0 versus 8-1 is NOT considered tied because they are separated by "one full game" (in baseball parlance). Another scenario worth mentioning is one in which we have a 9-0 team, an 8-0 team, and an 8-1 team. In this case we will use the below listed criteria to first determine the winner of the half. The two teams eligible for winner are the 9-0 and 8-0 teams. After that is determined, we will then figure out the runner-up for the half. If the 9-0 team lost on the basis of tiebreaker criteria to the 8-0 team for the winner position then it automatically gets the runner-up position for the half on the basis of its full game lead over the 8-1 team. However, if the 9-0 team won the half on the basis of the tiebreaker criteria, then we have to apply the tiebreaker criteria again to determine the runner-up (between the 8-0 team and the 8-1 team).

Tiebreaker Criteria for Determining Half Winners and Half Runners-up:

1. Overall Season Record by at least "one full game." (For example 12-6 does NOT beat 11-6.)
2. Head to Head competition for the Half in question, assuming all involved teams have played each other at least once for the Half in question. Again, the "at least one full game" rule is in effect.
3. Head to Head competition for the entire season. Again, the "at least one full game" rule is in effect.
4. Lowest Total Draw Shot Measurement (see Draw Shot Guidelines)
5. Coin Flip amongst teams still remaining in contention.

Tiebreaker Criteria for Determining Shift Wild Cards: A Shift Wild Card, where applicable, is the team with the best overall season record on that shift which did not qualify as either a half winner or half runner-up.

1. Overall Season Record by at least "one full game." (For example 12-6 does NOT beat 11-6.)
2. Head to Head competition for the entire season. Again, the "at least one full game" rule is in effect.
3. Lowest Total for Draw Shot Measurement (see Draw Shot Guidelines)
4. Coin Flip amongst teams still remaining in contention.

Tiebreaker Criteria for Determining "Event Wild Cards": An Event Wild Card is a team from the entire Mansfield Event with the best overall season record by at least one full game, which did not qualify via any of the above described channels. This assumes every team is scheduled to play the same number of games, +/- one. Special circumstances, such as weather cancellations, shall be handled by The Games Committee. In case of a tie, the following criteria determine the Event Wild Card.

1. Lowest Total for Draw Shot Measurement (see Draw Shot Guidelines)
2. Coin Flip amongst teams still in contention.

Draw Principles for Playoffs:

The top four seeds will be determined using the *Tiebreaker Criteria for Determining "Event Wild Cards."* These teams will receive the byes in the first round.

The assignment of teams to the draw sheet will follow the principles in the order listed below where possible. Event wild cards may prevent this in certain circumstances:

1. Teams from the same shift will be distributed as evenly as possible across the draw. When possible, no teams from the same shift will play each other in the first or second round.
2. Teams will be seeded by overall record (and Draw Shot Measurement) but the seeding will be altered to provide that no team plays a team from its shift in the first or second round, when possible.

Draw Shot Guidelines:
The Draw Shot Measurement will be used for tie-breaking purposes and will follow the guidelines outlined below:

1. Draw shots shall be completed and recorded by the completion of the final game of the first half for your shift. Teams that fail to complete the Draw Shot by that time will be marked as "X", which is ranked below 72" for purposes of tiebreakers.
2. Please be considerate of time and subsequent shifts when deciding to complete your draw shot. Draw shots may not be thrown if it is already past the start time of the next shift.
3. One team member shall throw one stone (no practice stones) with two sweepers at the conclusion of the game and a measurement to the nearest ½" taken from the button.
4. Draw shots must be thrown by an official member of the team (no subs). A player who was a sub in the game may sweep or hold the broom.
5. The skip or vice-skip of the opposing team shall complete the measurement. This measurement is to be agreed upon by the throwing team's skip or vice-skip and the individual completing the measurement, and recorded on the event schedules located on the bulletin board. Failure to touch the house results in a measurement of 72".
6. Should both teams desire to throw in one evening, the first stone is to be removed from play after the measurement is complete.
7. Measuring tapes will be located with the pebble can in the equipment room, along the back wall on the home end of the icehouse, or other designated area.

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